Guttmacher Institute
A Leading Non-Profit Research and Policy Organization Committed to
Advancing Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights
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Title of Research Project: Cognitive Interviews on Reporting of Reproductive Health Behavior

Principal Investigator: Dr. Laura Lindberg
Project Lead: Dr. Alicia VandeVusse

Introduction: This form explains the study you are invited to join, and asks for your permission to start. Please read this carefully and ask questions before you agree to join. If there is anything that you do not understand, please ask me to explain. You may ask questions at any time. It is your choice whether you want to be part of this study. Your participation is completely voluntary.

Purpose of Research Project: This study is testing new ways of asking about abortion. We are talking to 60 women aged 18-49. The study is being done by the Guttmacher Institute, a non-profit research organization committed to advancing sexual and reproductive health and rights in the United States and globally.

Procedures: If you agree to be in this study, a researcher from our team will ask you questions in a private location. The interview will last 90 minutes. The researcher will ask about your experiences with abortion and ask for your feedback. We will audio record the conversation so we can remember what was said. If you do not want to be audio recorded, we will stop the study. The audio recording will be saved to a private, password-protected server of a professional agency where they will type up the conversation so we have a written copy of what was said. Any information that could identify you will be taken out or changed.

[For video interview participants only:] We will delete the video part of our conversation and only keep the audio recording.

You will receive $150 for your time. I am also going to give you my card so you can reach me if you have questions or want a copy of the study results.

Confidentiality: Everything you say will be kept confidential, or secret. Your name will not be saved or attached to our conversation. Nothing you tell us during the interview will be shared with your name, and we will destroy anything with your name or other identifying information at the end of the study.

Risks: There is no known physical risk from this study. However, you will be asked personal questions; some could make you uncomfortable. You can skip questions you do not want to answer or stop the study at any time. Once we're done talking I can give you a list of organizations that help with topics we talk about.

There is a small risk of the loss of confidentiality. To protect your identity, we keep the data locked up or password protected. We will never use the data for non-scientific purposes. We will not tell anyone who you are when we talk about this study. All

research team members have signed agreements to protect confidentiality. All study documents have been approved by the Guttmacher Institute's federally registered Institutional Review Board.

A Certificate of Confidentiality (CoC) from the National Institutes of Health applies to this research. With this Certificate, the researchers will not share or use information that may identify you in any federal, state, or local civil, criminal, administrative, legislative, or other action, suit, or proceeding, or be used as evidence, for example, if there is a court subpoena. Information protected by this Certificate cannot be shared with anyone else who is not connected with the research unless there is a federal, state, or local law that requires disclosure (such as a mandate to report abuse of minors), but otherwise would ***not*** allow sharing the information for federal, state, or local civil, criminal, administrative, legislative, or other proceedings.

Exceptions to Confidentiality: Everything you say during our conversation will be confidential, or kept private. However, if you told me that you were in a situation where someone less than 18 years old might be seriously harmed, I might have to let social services know.

Benefits: There is no known benefit to you by doing this study.

Potential for research team to be in the room: It could be helpful to have another researcher in the room during your interview. Everyone on the team signed documents promising to keep your identity and answers secret. You can be in the study whether you say yes or no (see *Optional Consent* below).

Potential for Data Sharing: If you agree, the transcript of your interview may be shared with researchers at other organizations in the future. We will take out or change any information that could identify you before sharing. You can be in the study whether you agree to data sharing or not (see *Optional Consent* below).

Persons to Contact: If you have any questions about the study, you can contact the Project Lead, Alicia VandeVusse, at 212.248.1111 x2343, or email her at avandevusse@guttmacher.org.

If you have any questions or concerns about the study that you wish to discuss with someone not on the project team, you can talk to the chair of the Institutional Review Board of the Guttmacher Institute, Julie F. Kay, at 646.469.4320.

Verbal consent to participate in study:

I have read this form. I understand that my participation in this interview is completely voluntary and that all information I provide will be kept confidential. I agree to participate.

Do you understand this information?

Do you have any questions about this information?

Do you agree to participate in this study?

An unsigned copy of this consent form must be offered to the participant.

Optional consent to have others in the research team in the room:

Do you agree to allow a member of the research team, other than your interviewer, in the room during your interview?

- ❑ Yes
- ❑ No

Participant ID: _____

Optional consent to data-sharing:

Do you agree to allow a written copy of your interview to be shared with other researchers in the future?

- ❑ Yes
- ❑ No

Participant ID: _____